

Systems Approach to Student Athlete Scheduling

INTERVIEW OBSERVATIONS

1. School systems are not currently designed with athlete needs in mind. The current system forces students to adapt their personal lives instead of the system supporting them.

2. Most chaotic time for them are the afternoons and evenings after-school hours feel the most rushed or chaotic due to:

- Transitioning from school to practice.**
- Lack of buffer time between events.**
- Commutes, meals, and preparation compressing available time.**

"I woke up and it's already 10pm."(quote from the interview)

3. Most productive time is at night or rest days

- Majority complete academic work late at night or on Sundays/rest days.**
- This results in sleep deprivation and also loss of true rest.**
- Due to this pressure both physical exertion and academic output affect performance on both ends.**

4. Coping strategies are improvised

- Tools like Google Calendar are used, but one student creates daily plans manually.**
- None of them described an integrated or guided scheduling system.**

5. Desire for Customization in Academics

All four wanted curriculum flexibility

- Drop unnecessary subjects.**
- Focus on useful or career-aligned subjects.**
- Early school endings or recordings to have free time.**

PROBLEMS

- 1.They have limited control over academic time**
- 2.Their transition period is poorly managed and is a very small window to rest and re energise.**
- 3.They tend to have weak time priority and task scheduling causing them to stay up late**
- 4. An absence of a consistent scheduling system or habit exists**
- 5.They have lack of focus for goal aligned tasks but more for academics but they want to switch that**
- 6.There is no coordination between sport and academic responsibilities and scheduling**

Insights from Follow-Up Questions

- 1.They have mentioned the main reason for the schedule being chaotic or hectic is their homework.**
- 2.Video recording of lectures will be of great help**
- 3.They prefer to focus and spend more time on subjects they know are going to help them later on .**
- 4.All of them agreed to an arc suggestion I made**
The arc suggestion's main point was that they would prefer 1 day being packed, the other day being a little easier and then all the days go on as an arc of complexity .